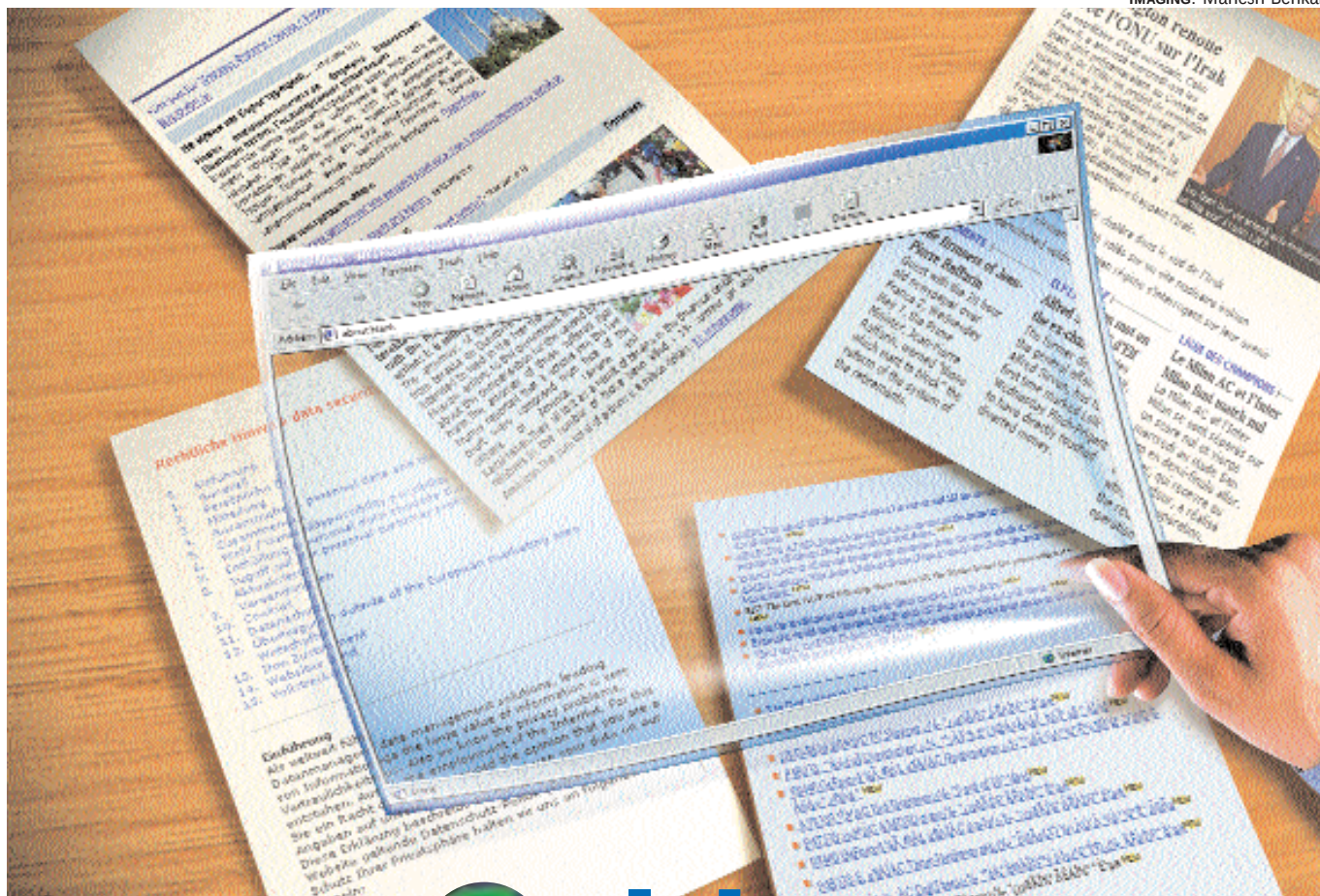




One world, One language

¿Usted habla español? Well neither do we, but you no longer need to speak, read or write a language to be able to communicate using it...

“**G**lückwünsche”, the subject line of the e-mail screams. You click on it and gibberish shows up. Who wants to continue reading a mail that begins, “Ihr Stellengesuch auf Mercedes Benz wurde angenommen.” You instinctively click on Delete, and perhaps even block the sender, but had you translated the text, you would have found that the e-mail reads “Congratulations! Your job application to Mercedes Benz was accepted.” Kicking ourselves, aren’t we?

Many of us would like to talk to our Japanese correspondents in Japan, or have e-pals in Russia, but who has the time to learn Japanese or Russian?

But now, the Net is shrinking the world

in more ways than one. Web sites with translation engines bridge the language divide by offering free and paid translation services for all major languages. Small or medium-sized businesses can now avail of cheap translation solutions, and jump over the language barriers that hinder growth on foreign lands. Net surfers don’t have to miss out on relevant content they find in foreign languages.

Sites and Services

Systran Information and Translation Technologies is one of the biggest players in the translation software business, and has an admirable 30 years experience in the field. Systran’s translation engine is gen-

erally considered the best. Some other translation engine providers are Free-translation.com, PROMT-Reverso and WorldLingo.

Popular sites such as Google and Dictionary.com offer what is known as ‘Machine translation’, which, while not as competent as a human translator, conveys the gist of the text. For example, Google would translate that German e-mail as ‘Their job application on Mercedes Benz was accepted’—not entirely correct, but it gets the message across.

The most popular sites are obviously the ones that offer free translation. Google offers a wide range of translation services, ranging from translating text and Web